

Alienware 18 Area-51

Big, bold, and built to dominate

Alienware 18 Area-51, launched earlier this year is a complete gaming rig for anyone looking for a portable gaming setup without any compromises. However, it also comes with a hefty price tag. The real question now is- what do you get at a price where a full gaming PC is also an option? Read on...

NOT YOUR TYPICAL LAPTOP

When the Alienware got delivered to my home in a huge box, my family's first, and perhaps the most honest, reaction was: Is this a TV? At 4.3 kg (without its charger), the Alienware 18 Area-51 stands its ground as a gaming powerhouse, which is here to give you a desktop-level feel. This isn't a laptop you'll casually slide into a backpack. I tried carrying it to work for three days straight in my backpack along with my daily driver, a MacBook Air 15-inch, and let's just say my back got an unintended workout. Even my car's seatbelt sensor refused to acknowledge that this was a laptop and forced me to buckle it in like a passenger.

The 360 W charger also comes with a large 16-amp plug, which means you won't be able to charge the laptop in a regular power socket. You will need a larger socket, which isn't that easy to find. For me, this problem was solved by buying a converter multiplug for Rs 120 on Amazon.

Coming to the design of the laptop, the teal colour is subtle yet distinctive. It moves away from the usual black and grey colour options, giving the machine a premium and sophisticated look. The dark colour also pairs well with the RGB accents, making the laptop feel both sleek and commanding without

₹4,95,990



being overly flashy. At the back, Alienware's signature logo lights up on the lid, and a strip around the connectivity ports creates a smooth gradient effect. At the bottom of the laptop, there is a small section covered with glass that lets you in on the action inside and gives the whole laptop a futuristic touch. Even though I initially had my concerns about the glass, it seems pretty durable, and I didn't notice any scratches forming on it. With that being said, I did notice some smudges and dust forming on the lid after just two weeks of usage, so it is recommended to clean this gaming rig regularly.

DISPLAY

When it comes to gaming experience, the display quality matters a lot. After all, you would want to experience the game's graphics in all their glory. And the 18-inch WQXGA display is one of the laptop's highlights. With a 300Hz

refresh rate and 500 nits brightness, the screen is sharp, fluid, and accurate. Colours pop without oversaturation, and at 130% sRGB, this is a panel you can use comfortably for both gaming and content creation.

During our testing, it was revealed that the display comes with a 99.4% DCI-P3 colour gamut. Further, the tests showed an average Delta E of 2.4, which means colour reproduction is precise enough even for professional editing. This is more than the likes of MSI TITAN GT77HX, Acer Predator PH315-55s and MSI Raider GE67HX 12UHS.

In a nutshell, I enjoyed playing some of my favourite games on this display. Be it cruising around the streets of Mexico in Forza Horizon 5 or peaking through the doors in fear while playing Silent Hill f, the experience was a delight, both in a well-lit office environment as well as outdoors.

KEYBOARD AND AUDIO

The keyboard backlighting, as with other Alienware models, is customisable via the Alienware Command Centre. Not just the keys, even the trackpad lights up when you touch it and enhances the appeal of the laptop. The trackpad isn't too large either and supports multi-touch gestures. Now, you don't really use the touchpad for gaming and keeping that in mind, the touchpad here does its job well. Alongside the touchpad is ample space to rest your arms. However, the chassis easily smudges.

Moving on to the audio experience, no gaming rig is complete without one. Dell has that department covered with

